QUICK GUIDE

SNARE & HI-HAT WAVEFORM

What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

The snare is a short, sharp hit with a lot of mid and high energy, usually landing on beats 2 and 4. The hi-hat is a thin, bright tick that repeats quickly.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Snare: crack. Hat: tick and shimmer.



01

SNARE: THE BACKBEAT

A sharp spike on beats 2 and 4 in most dance music.

02

HI-HAT: FAST TICKS

Small, frequent spikes, often on the off-beat.

03

FILLS ARE A SIGNAL

A snare roll or hat build warns you a drop is coming.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Find 2 and 4 by the snare. Count to the next fill.

- [ ] Find beats 2 and 4 by spotting the snare.
- [ ] Count the bars to the next fill or hat build.
- [ ] Land your transition when the phrase restarts.



PRACTICE & CHECK

SNARE & HI-HAT WAVEFORM: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Finding beats 2 and 4 to know where you are in the bar.
- Hearing off-beat hats to feel the groove.
- Spotting snare rolls and hat builds before a drop.

QUICK CHECK

1. Which beats does the snare usually hit?

2. What does a hi-hat look like?

3. What does a snare roll usually signal?

Answer key: 1) 2 and 4. 2) Small, fast, frequent spikes. 3) A drop or phrase change is coming.

REMEMBER

The kick is the pulse. Snare and hat are the map.

YOUR NOTES

